

0.0.1 The sheaf of barley

1. Suppose O bhikkhus, that a sheaf of barley were to be laid down at the cross-roads. Then six men would come with flail in hand. They would strike that sheaf of barley with the six flails. Thus indeed, O bhikkhus, that sheaf of barley would be well-beaten, being struck with the six flails. Then a seventh man would come with flail in hand. He would strike that sheaf of barley with the seventh flail. Thus indeed O bhikkhus, that sheaf of barley would be even more thoroughly well-beaten, being struck with the seventh flail.

2. So too, O bhikkhus, the Dhamma-deaf puthujjana is struck in the eye with agree-

yavakalāpīsuttam

seyyathāpi bhikkhave yavakalāpī cātumma-hāpathe nikkhattā assa. atha cha purisā āgaccheyyūṃ vyābhaṅgihatthā. ne te yavakalāpiṃ chahi vyābhaṅgihi haneyyūṃ. evaṃ hi sā bhikkhave yavakalāpī suhatā assa chahi vyābhaṅgihi haññamānā. atha sattamo puriso āgaccheyya vyābhaṅgi-hattho. so taṃ yavakalāpiṃ sattamāya vyābhaṅgiyā haneyya. evaṃ hi sā bhikkhave yavakalāpī suhata-tarā assa sattamāya vyābhaṅgiyā haññamānā.

evameva kho bhikkhave assutavā puthujjano cakkhus-miṃ haññati manā-

able and disagreeable forms, struck in the ear with agreeable and disagreeable sounds, struck in the nose with agreeable and disagreeable aromas, struck in the tongue with agreeable and disagreeable flavors, struck in the body with agreeable and disagreeable tangibles, struck in the mind with agreeable and disagreeable dhammas. If, O bhikkhus, that Dhamma-deaf puthujjana is intent on a future renewal of being, then indeed, O bhikkhus, that empty man is more thoroughly well-beaten, just as, O bhikkhus, that sheaf of barley, having been even more thoroughly well-beaten, being struck with the seventh flail.

3. Once upon a time, O bhikkhus, the devas and the asuras were arrayed for a battle. Then, O bhikkhus,

pāmanāpehi rūpehi, sotasmiṃ haññati manāpāmanāpehi saddehi, ghānasmim haññati manāpāmanāpehi gandhehi, jivhāya haññati manāpāmanāpehi rassehi, kāyasmim haññati manāpāmanāpehi phoṭṭhabbehi, manasmim haññati manāpāmanāpehi dhammehi. sace so bhikkhave assutavā puthujjano āyatim punabbhavāya ceteti evaṃ hi so bhikkhave moghapuriso suhatataro hoti, seyyathāpi bhikkhave sā yavakalāpī satta-māya vyābhaṅgiyā haññamānā.

bhūtapubbaṃ bhikkhave, devāsurasaṅgāmo samupab-būlho ahosi. atha kho bhikkhave vepa-

Vepacitti, the ruler of the asuras, addressed the asuras: “If dear sirs, in this imminent battle between the devas and the asuras, should the asuras be victorious and the devas defeated, having bound Sakka, ruler of the devas, with the neck-as-the-fifth bondage, you must bring him to my presence in the city of the asuras.” Sakka too, O bhikkhus, the ruler of the devas addressed the Tavatimsa devas: “If dear sirs, in this imminent battle between the devas and the asuras, should the devas be victorious and the asuras defeated, having bound Vepacitti, ruler of the asuras, with the neck-as-the-fifth bondage, you must bring him to my presence in sudhamma, hall of the devas.”

4. But in that battle, O bhik-

citti asurindo asure āmantesi: “sace mārīsā, devāsurasañgāme samupabbūḷhe, asurā jineyyuṃ devā parājineyyuṃ, yena naṃ¹ sakkaṃ devānamindaṃ kaṇṭhapañcamehi bandhanehi bandhitvā mama santike āneyyātha asurapuranti”. sakkopi kho bhikkhave devānamindo deve tāvatimse āmantesi: “sace mārīsā devāsurasañgāme samupabbūḷhe devā jineyyuṃ asurā parājineyyuṃ, yena naṃ vepacittiṃ² asurindaṃ kaṇṭhapañcamehi bandhanehi bandhitvā mama santike āneyyātha sudhamma devasabhanti”³.

tasmiṃ kho pana bhikkhave saṅgāme

khus, the devas were victorious and the asuras were defeated. So, O bhikkhus, the Tavatimsa devas, having bound Vepacitti, ruler of the asuras, with the neck-as-the-fifth bondage, brought him to the presence of Sakka, ruler of the devas, in sudhamma, hall of the devas.

5. Just there, O bhikkhus, Vepacitti, ruler of the Asuras, was bounded with the neck-as-the-fifth bondage. When, O bhikkhus, it occurred to Vepacitti, ruler of the asuras, thus: “The devas are righteous, the asuras are unrighteous. Right now I go just here, to the city of the devas,” then he perceived himself freed from the neck-as-the-fifth bondage, causing to amuse himself, being furnished and endowed with the five cords of celestial sensual pleasures. But when, O bhik-

devā jinim̐su asurā parājiniṃsu. atha kho bhikkhave devā tāvatimsā vepacittim̐ asurindaṃ kaṇṭhapañcamehi bandhanehi bandhitvā sakkassa devānamin-dassa santike āne-suṃ sudhammadeva-sabhaṃ.

tatra sudaṃ bhikkhave, vepacitti asurindo kaṇṭhapañcamehi bandhanehi baddho⁴ hoti. yadā kho bhikkhave, vepacittissa asurindassa evaṃ hoti; “dhammikā kho devā adhammikā asurā, idhevadānāhaṃ⁵ devapuram̐⁶ gacchāmī”ti. atha kaṇṭhapañcamehi bandhanehi muttam at-tānaṃ samanupas-sati, dibbehi pañcākāmaguṇehi samap-

khus, it occurred to Vepacitti, ruler of the asuras, thus:
 “The asuras are righteous, the devas are unrighteous. Right now I go just there, to the city of the asuras,” then he perceived himself bounded with the neck-as-the-fifth bondage, deprived of the five cords of celestial sensual pleasures.

6. So subtle, O bhikkhus, is the bondage of Vepacitti. More subtle than that is the bondage of Mara. Conceiving, O bhikkhus, one is in the bondage of Mara. Not conceiving, one is freed from the Evil One.

7. “I am.” O bhikkhus, this is a conceiving. “This I am.” This is a conceiving. “Will

pito samāṅgībhūto paricāreti. yadā ca kho bhikkhave vepacittissa asurindassa evaṃ hoti: dhammikā kho asurā, adhammikā devā, tattheva dānāhaṃ asurapuram gamissāmi, atha kaṇṭhapañca-mehi bandhanehi baddhaṃ¹ attānaṃ samanupassati; dibbehi ca pañcakāmaguṇehi parihāyati.

evaṃ sukhumaṃ kho bhikkhave vepacittibandhanaṃ. tato sukhumataraṃ mārabandhanaṃ. maññaṃāno bhikkhave, baddho² mārassa, amaññaṃāno mutto pāpimato.

asmīti bhikkhave maññitametaṃ, aya-mahasmaṃti maññitametaṃ, bhavis-

be.” This is a conceiving. “Will not be.” This is a conceiving. “Will be possessed of form.” This is a conceiving. “Will be formless.” This is a conceiving. “Will be percipient.” This is a conceiving. “Will be non-percipient.” This is a conceiving. “Will be neither percipient nor non-percipient.” This is a conceiving. To conceive is a disease, to conceive is a tumor, to conceive is a dart. Therefore, O bhikkhus, “We will dwell with a mind free from conceivings.” Thus indeed for you, O bhikkhus, should it be trained.

8. “I am.” O bhikkhus, this is a perturbation. “This I am.” This is a perturbation. “Will be.” This is a perturbation. “Will not be.” This is a perturbation. “Will be possessed of form.” This is a perturbation.

santi maññitame-
taṃ, na bhavissanti
maññitametaṃ, rūpī
bhavissanti maññi-
tametaṃ, arūpī bha-
vissanti maññitame-
taṃ, saññī bhavis-
santi maññitametaṃ,
asaññī bhavissanti
maññitametaṃ, ne-
vasaññīnāsaññī bha-
vissanti maññitame-
taṃ; maññitaṃ bhik-
khava rogo, mañ-
ñitaṃ gaṇḍo, mañ-
ñitaṃ sallāṃ. tas-
mātiha bhikkhave
amaññamānena ce-
tasā viharissāmāti,
evaṃ hi vo bhikkhave
sikkhitabbāṃ.

asmīti bhikkhave iñ-
jitametaṃ, ayamaha-
masmīti iñjitametaṃ,
bhavissanti iñjita-
taṃ, na bhavissanti
iñjitametaṃ, rūpī
bhavissanti iñjita-
metaṃ, arūpī bha-

“Will be formless.” This is a perturbation. “Will be percipient.” This is a perturbation. “Will be non-percipient.” This is a perturbation. “Will be neither percipient nor non-percipient.” This is a perturbation. To be perturbed is a disease, to be perturbed is a tumor, to be perturbed is a dart. Therefore, O bhikkhus, “We will dwell with a mind free from perturbations.” Thus indeed for you, O bhikkhus, should it be trained.

9. “I am.” O bhikkhus, this is an agitation. “This I am.” This is an agitation. “Will be.” This is an agitation. “Will not be.” This is an agitation. “Will be possessed of form.” This is an agitation. “Will be formless.” This is an agitation. “Will be percipient.” This is an agitation. “Will be non-percipient.” This is an agitation. “Will be neither percipient nor

vissanti iñjitametam, saññī bhavissanti iñ-jitametaṃ, asaññī bhavissanti iñjita-metaṃ, nevasaññī-nāsaññī bhavissanti iñjitametam. iñjitaṃ bhikkhave rogo, iñ-jitaṃ gaṇḍo, iñjitaṃ sallam. tasmātiha bhikkhave aniñjamā-nena cetasā viharis-sāmāti, evaṃ hi vo bhikkhave sikkhitab-baṃ.

asmīti bhikkhave phanditametaṃ, aya-mahasmīti phan-ditametaṃ, bhavis-santi phanditame-taṃ, na bhavissanti phanditametaṃ, rūpī bhavissanti phan-ditametaṃ, arūpī bhavissanti phan-ditametaṃ, saññī bhavissanti phan-ditametaṃ, asaññī bhavissanti phan-

non-percipient.” This is an agitation. To be agitated is a disease, to be agitated is a tumor, to be agitated is a dart. Therefore, O bhikkhus, “We will dwell with a mind free from agitations.” Thus indeed for you, O bhikkhus, should it be trained.

10. “I am.” O bhikkhus, this is papanca. “This I am.” This is papanca. “Will be.” This is papanca. “Will not be.” This is papanca. “Will be possessed of form.” This is papanca. “Will be formless.” This is papanca. “Will be percipient.” This is papanca. “Will be non-percipient.” This is papanca. “Will be neither percipient nor non-percipient.” This is papanca. Papanca is a disease, papanca is a tumor, papanca is a dart. Therefore, O bhikkhus, “We

ditametam, nevasaññīnāsaññī bhavissanti phanditametam; phanditam bhikkhave rogo, phanditam gaṇḍo, phanditam sallam. tas-mātiha bhikkhave aphan-damānena cetasā viharissāmāti evaṃ hi vo bhikkhave sikkhitabbam.

asmīti¹ bhikkhave papañcitametam, ayamahamasmīti papañcitametam bhavissanti papañcitametam na bhavissanti papañcitametam, rūpī bhavissanti papañcitametam, arūpī bhavissanti papañcitametam, saññī bhavissanti papañcitametam, asaññī bhavissanti papañcitametam, nevasaññīnāsaññī bhavissanti

will dwell with a mind free from papanca.” Thus indeed for you, O bhikkhus should it be trained.

11. “I am.” O bhikkhus, this is an entrenchment in conceit. “This I am.” This is an entrenchment in conceit. “Will be.” This is an entrenchment in conceit. “Will not be.” This is an entrenchment in conceit. “Will be possessed of form.” This is an entrenchment in conceit. “Will be formless.” This is an entrenchment in conceit. “Will be percipient.” This is an entrenchment in conceit. “Will be non-percipient.” This is an entrenchment in conceit. “Will be neither percipient nor non-percipient.” This is

papañcitametam, papañcitam bhikkhave rogo, papañcitam gaṇḍo, papañcitam sallam. tasmātiha bhikkhave nippapañcārāmena cetasā viharissāmāti, evaṃ hi vo bhikkhave sikkhitabbam.

asmīti¹ bhikkhave mānagatametam, ayamahamasmīti mānagatametam, bhavissanti mānagatametam, na bhavissanti mānagatametam, rūpī bhavissanti mānagatametam, arūpī bhavissanti mānagatametam, saññī bhavissanti mānagatametam, asaññī bhavissanti mānagatametam, nevasaññī nāsaññī bhavissanti mānagatametam. mānagatametam

an entrenchment in conceit. Entrenchment in conceit is a disease, entrenchment in conceit is a tumor, entrenchment in conceit is a dart. Therefore, O bhikkhus, “We will dwell with a mind free from entrenchment in conceit.” Thus indeed for you, O bhikkhus, should it be trained.

bhikkhave rogo, mānagatametam gaṇḍo, mānagatametam sallam. tasmātiha bhikkhave, nihata-mānena cetasā viharissāmāti, evam hi vo bhikkhave sikkhitabbanti.

